



**Verified Carbon
Standard**

FX GROUP BIOMASS TO ENERGY PROJECT



BRUNDTLAND

Project title	FX Group Biomass to Energy Project
Project ID	5102
Crediting period	12-10-2022 to 11-10-2029
Original date of issue	13-05-2024
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Prepared by	Brundtland (Pty) Ltd.

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1 PROJECT DETAILS

1.1 Summary Description of the Project

The FX group Biomass to Energy Project (hereinafter, the Project) is developed by FX Group (Pty) Ltd. (hereinafter, the Project Proponent) and is a woody biomass residue utilization project. The proposed project activity concerns a greenfield biomass to energy power plant at the FX Group Lothair facility, which is situated in the Mpumalanga province of South Africa, in the eastern region of the country, bordering the nations of Mozambique and Eswatini. The facility manufactures high-quality engineered wood panel products.

The Project will source biomass from local sawmills and biomass wastes from the FX Group's Lothair operation for the generation of electricity in a power-only plant. The woody biomass will be fed into a biomass boiler to create super-heated high-pressure steam. The steam is used to spin a 4.5MW power output steam turbine and electrical generator. The proposed project activity provides renewable energy to FX Group's Lothair industrial facility, with an estimated 20 463 MWh generation per year.

The renewable energy produced by the plant will displace the grid electricity, which would have been used to power the industrial facility in the absence of the biomass power plant. Electricity on the South African National grid is largely generated by the state-owned entity Eskom and is highly carbon-intensive due to the reliance on fossil-fuels such as coal and diesel. The Project is expected to provide average GHG reductions of 19 370 tCO₂e per year.

1.2 Audit History

Audit type	Period	Program	Validation/verification body name	Number of years
Validation/verification	(DD-Month-YYYY–DD-Month-YYYY)	VCS	Validation/verification body name	One year
	...			

1.3 Sectoral Scope and Project Type

Sectoral scope ¹	1. Energy (renewable/non-renewable)
Project activity type	Non-grouped

¹ Projects, activities, or methodologies may be developed under any of the 16 VCS sectoral scopes: <https://verra.org/programs/verified-carbon-standard/vcs-program-details/#sectoral-scopes>

1.4 Project Eligibility

1.4.1 General eligibility

The scope of the VCS program includes the seven Kyoto Protocol greenhouse gases, one of which is CO₂. The emission reductions from the proposed project activity will result from reduced CO₂ emissions due to the avoided use of carbon-intensive national grid electricity, or of fossil-fuel based captive plant electricity, which are replaced by renewable energy from a biomass energy plant.

The Lothair site at which the project activity occurs has not generated GHG emissions primarily for their subsequent reduction, removal or destruction. The FX Group's Lothair mill is constructed to create a particle board production line to improve the group's operational and manufacturing capacity.

The project applies a CDM methodology approved under the VCS program, namely 'AMS-I.F Renewable Electricity Generation for captive use and mini-grid v5.0'. The methodology is classified as "active" on the CDM website.

Finally, the proposed project activity is not excluded from the scope of the VCS program via the stipulations stated the standard's Table 1: Excluded Project Activities and is therefore eligible under the program. The project concerns electricity generation using residues from sustainably sourced biomass, which would have otherwise not been utilized.

1.5 Project Design

- ☒ Single location or installation
- ☐ Multiple locations or project activity instances (but not a grouped project)
- ☐ Grouped project

1.6 Project Proponent

Organization name	FX Group (Pty) Ltd.
Contact person	Mr. Roddy Payne
Title	General Manager
Address	10 Bradford St, Benoni South, Benoni, East Rand, Gauteng, 1501, South Africa
Telephone	+ 27 11 422 4839 / +27 71 611 8168

Email	rpayne@thefxgroup.co.za
Organization name	Brundtland (Pty) Ltd.
Contact person	Mr. Henk Sa
Title	Director
Address	Firestation, 16 Baker Street, Rosebank, 2196, Gauteng, South Africa
Telephone	+27 11 447 7892 / +27 78 459 5748
Email	Henk.sa@brundtland.co.za

1.7 Other Entities Involved in the Project

Organization name	
Role in the project	
Contact person	
Title	
Address	
Telephone	
Email	

1.8 Ownership

FX Group (Pty) Ltd. is the project proponent in that it has overall control and responsibility for the Project. It has the sole right to the GHG emission reductions or removals for the project crediting period.

Project ownership arises according to property or contractual right in the plant, equipment and process that generates GHG emission reductions, as per the VCS Standard v4.7 section 3.7, paragraph 3.7.1, evidence type 3. Project ownership is demonstrated by unit handover documentation from the EPC contractor, which supports the property and contractual ownership of the plant by the project proponent.

1.9 Project Start Date

Project start date	12-Oct-2022
Justification	The project start date is the commissioning date of the biomass power generation plant, which is the date of the first GHG emission reduction.

1.10 Project Crediting Period

Crediting period	☒ Seven years, twice renewable ☐ Ten years, fixed ☐ Other (state the selected crediting period and justify how it conforms with the VCS Program requirements)
Start and end date of first or fixed crediting period	12-Oct-2022 to 11-Oct-2029

1.11 Project Scale and Estimated GHG Emission Reductions or Removals

Indicate the estimated annual GHG emission reductions/removals (ERRs) of the project:

- ☒ < 300,000 tCO₂e/year (project)
☐ ≥ 300,000 tCO₂e/year (large project)

Complete the table below for the first (if renewable) or fixed crediting period:

Calendar year of crediting period	Estimated GHG emission reductions or removals (tCO ₂ e)
12-Oct-2022 to 31-Dec-2022	4 251
01-Jan-2023 to 31-Dec-2023	19 370
01-Jan-2024 to 31-Dec-2024	19 370
01-Jan-2025 to 31-Dec-2025	19 370
01-Jan-2026 to 31-Dec-2026	19 370
01-Jan-2027 to 31-Dec-2027	19 370
01-Jan-2028 to 31-Dec-2028	19 370
01-Jan-2029 to 11-Oct-2029	15 119

Total estimated ERRs during the first or fixed crediting period	135 590
Total number of years	7
Average annual ERRs	19 370

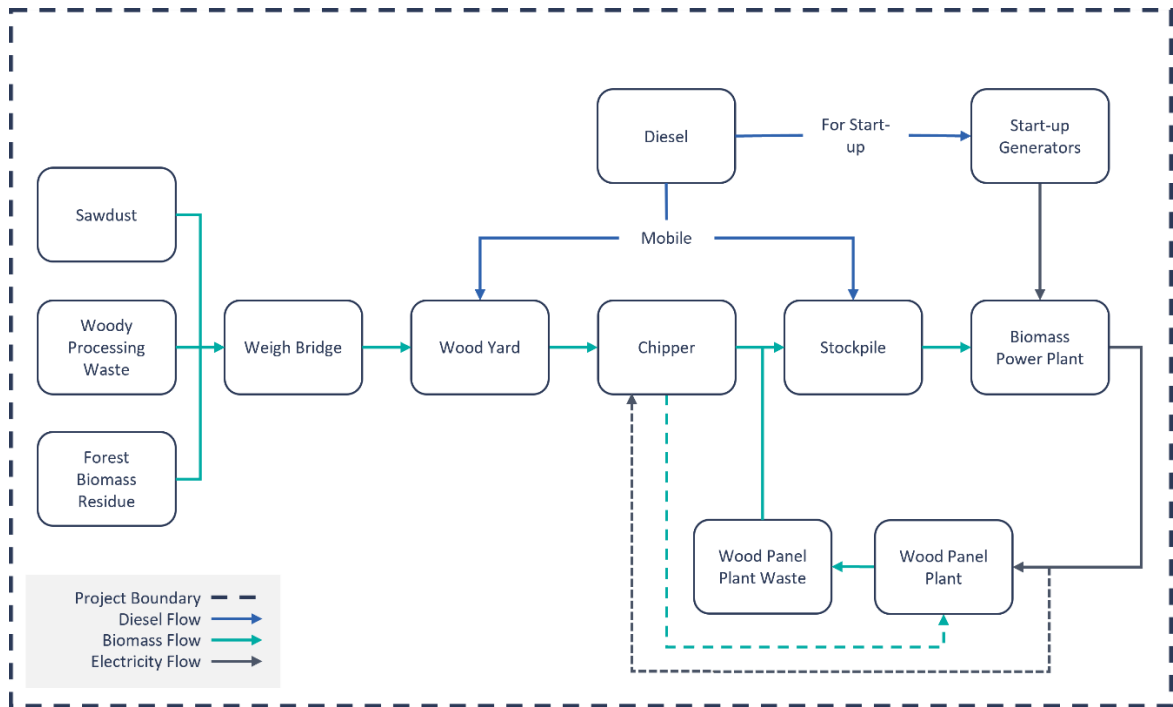
1.12 Description of the Project Activity

The project activity consists of a 4.5 MW greenfield biomass-to-energy power plant at the FX Group Lothair facility. The objective of the power plant is to burn waste biomass (such as sawmill or wood panel plant waste) and other biomass residues (such as clear-felling waste) to generate power using a conventional steam cycle electricity generation plant, which is then used to power the Lothair wood panel plant. The power plant is designed to fulfill all the electricity needs of the particle board manufacturing plant at any given point in time, to allow it to operate independently from the South Africa national grid. The technical specifications of the three main components of the power plant, i.e., the biomass boiler, steam turbine and electricity generator, are presented in the table below.

Biomass Boiler	Specification
Manufacturer	New Nation
Quantity	1 set
Rated evaporation capacity	22 t/h
Design pressure	4.2 MPa
Rated steam pressure	3.82 MPa
Rated steam temperature	450 °C
Design life	30 Years
Steam Turbine	Specification
Manufacturer	Hangzhou Hangfa Electrical Equipment CO., Ltd.
Model	N4.5-3.43
Quantity	1 set
Rated Output	4500 kW
Rated Steam Pressure	3.43 MPa
Rated Steam Temperature	445 °C

Rated Speed	3000 (r/min)
Design life	30 Years
Electricity Generator	Specifications
Manufacturer	Hangzhou Hangfa Electrical Equipment CO., Ltd.
Model	QF-J4.5-2
Quantity	1 set
Rated Power Capacity	5.625 MVA
Rated power	4.5 MW
Rated Voltage	11 kV
Rated Current	295.2 A
Exciting Current	241.6 A
Power factor	0.8
Frequency	50 HZ
Rated Speed	3000 (r/min)
Design life	30 Years

The biomass residues consist of eucalyptus and wattle, pine with bark and waste from sawmills. Incoming biomass is weighed via a weighbridge, after which they are transported to a wood-yard for storage. The biomass, including wastes from the plant's operation itself, is processed using a chipper. The shredded biomass and woodchips are subsequently moved to a stockpile after which they are fed to the boiler via a conveyer belt, where they are combusted at a rate of approximately 4 tonnes per hour. The complete process is depicted in the diagram below.



1.13 Project Location

The FX Group (Pty) Ltd. biomass-to-energy project is located within the Msukaligwa Local Municipality, 65 km northeast of Ermelo at R33, 2370, Lothair, Gert Sibande District Municipality, Mpumalanga Province, South Africa. The central coordinates of the project location are: -26.390478, 30.445225. The maps and satellite imagery below indicate the geographical location of the FX Group biomass to energy project.

South Africa



Mpumalanga Province



FX Group Biomass to Energy Plant Location



1.14 Conditions Prior to Project Initiation

The FX Group biomass to energy project is a greenfield project, which is being developed in conjunction with FX Group's Lothair integrated wood-based panel plant. The conditions prior to the project activity and construction of the board manufacturing facility comprises of an area in a natural state with no construction or industrial activity. The FX Group's Lothair particle board

mill is constructed to create a particle board line, a resin manufacturing plant and a melamine upgrading area, to improve the groups operations and manufacturing capacity. The powerplant will provide for the full electricity needs of the manufacturing plant and, therefore, the project has not been implemented to generate GHG emissions for the purpose of their subsequent reduction, removal or destruction.

1.15 Compliance with Laws, Statutes and Other Regulatory Frameworks

The Project complies with all relevant law and regulations of the Republic of South Africa. Compliance is evidenced by the following:

- Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA) / Environmental Authorization (EA) granted by the Department of Forestry, Fisheries and the Environment (DFFE) – Reference number 17/2/3 GS-226 (Approved)
- Water Use License – Reference number WU22918 (Submitted)
- Air Emissions License – Reference number APP ID: 4735 (Submitted)

The Project thereby complies with the South African National Environmental Management Act (NEMA) (No. 107 of 1998) and associated regulations.

1.16 Double Counting and Participation under Other GHG Programs

1.16.1 No Double Issuance

Is the project receiving or seeking credit for reductions and removals from a project activity under another GHG program?

☐ Yes ☒ No

1.16.2 Registration in Other GHG Programs

Has the project registered under any other GHG programs?

☐ Yes ☒ No

Is the project active under the other program?

☐ Yes ☒ No

1.16.3 Projects Rejected by Other GHG Programs

Has the project been rejected by any other GHG programs?

☐ Yes ☒ No

1.17 Double Claiming, Other Forms of Credit, and Scope 3 Emissions

1.17.1 No Double Claiming with Emissions Trading Programs or Binding Emission Limits

Are project reductions and removals or project activities also included in an emissions trading program or binding emission limit? See the *VCS Program Definitions* for definitions of emissions trading program and binding emission limit.

☐ Yes ☒ No

1.17.2 No Double Claiming with Other Forms of Environmental Credit

Has the project activity sought, received, or is planning to receive credit from another GHG-related environmental credit system? See the *VCS Program Definitions* for definition of GHG-related environmental credit system.

☐ Yes ☒ No

1.17.3 Supply Chain (Scope 3) Emissions

Do the project activities specified in Section 1.12 affect the emissions footprint of any product(s) (goods or services) that are part of a supply chain?

☒ Yes ☐ No

If yes:

Is the project proponent(s) or authorized representative a buyer or seller of the product(s) (goods or services) that are part of a supply chain?

☒ Yes ☐ No

If yes:

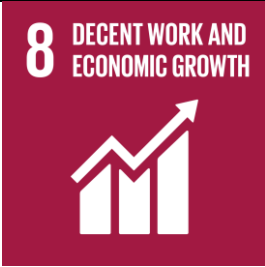
Has the project proponent(s) or authorized representative posted a public statement on their website saying, "Carbon credits may be issued through Verified Carbon Standard project [project ID] for the greenhouse gas emission reductions or removals associated with [project proponent or authorized representative organization name(s)] [name of product(s) whose emissions footprint is changed by the project activities]."

☐ Yes ☒ No

1.18 Sustainable Development Contributions

SDG 13		
	Target 13	Take urgent action to combat climate change and its impacts.
The FX Group biomass to energy project produces renewable energy, which results in the avoided use of carbon-intensive national grid electricity, which is generated primarily from fossil fuels such as coal and diesel. Therefore, the project activity contributes to reducing the tonnes of greenhouse gas emissions emitted by fossil-fuel driven power stations to power the Lothair industrial facility. This is in line with the objectives stated in South Africa's Nationally Determined Contribution (NCD) under the Paris Agreement and Low Emissions Development Strategy (LEDS)		

SDG 7		
	Target 7	Ensure access to affordable, reliable, sustainable and modern energy for all.
The FX group biomass to energy project produces renewable energy through the use of residual biomass and a biomass boiler to create super-heated steam which is required to spin a 4.5MW steam turbine electrical generator. By creating renewable energy for consumption at the FX Group Lothair facility, the project activity contributes to increasing the renewable energy share in the total final energy consumption. This is in line with the objectives stated in South Africa's Integrated Resource Plan (2019).		

SDG 8		
	Target 8	Promote sustained, inclusive and sustainable economic growth, full and productive employment and decent work for all.
The FX group biomass to energy project creates employment opportunities for the collection of biomass residue from nearby forestry plantations. FX Group purchases biomass residue		

from individuals who collect it from the nearby plantations and use it as fuel for their biomass boilers. By creating employment opportunities for surrounding communities, the project activity reduces the unemployment rate. This is in line with the objectives stated in the South African Constitution.

1.19 Additional Information Relevant to the Project

1.19.1 Leakage Management

To be included in the validated version.

1.19.2 Commercially Sensitive Information

To be included in the validated version.

1.19.3 Further Information

To be included in the validated version.

2 SAFEGUARDS AND STAKEHOLDER ENGAGEMENT

2.1 Stakeholder Engagement and Consultation

2.1.1 Stakeholder Identification

To be included in the validated version.

2.1.2 Stakeholder Consultation and Ongoing Communication

To be included in the validated version.

2.1.3 Free Prior and Informed Consent

To be included in the validated version.

2.1.4 Grievance Redress Procedure

To be included in the validated version.

2.1.5 Public Comments

To be included in the validated version.

2.2 Risks to Stakeholders and the Environment

2.2.1 Management Experience

To be included in the validated version.

2.2.2 Risk Assessment

To be included in the validated version.

2.3 Respect for Human Rights and Equity

2.3.1 Labor and Work

To be included in the validated version.

2.3.2 Human Rights

To be included in the validated version.

2.3.3 Indigenous Peoples and Cultural Heritage

To be included in the validated version.

2.3.4 Property Rights

To be included in the validated version.

2.3.5 Benefit Sharing

To be included in the validated version.

2.4 Ecosystem Health

To be included in the validated version.

2.4.1 Rare, Threatened, and Endangered Species

To be included in the validated version.

2.4.2 Introduction of Species

To be included in the validated version.

2.4.3 Ecosystem Conversion

To be included in the validated version.

3 APPLICATION OF METHODOLOGY

3.1 Title and Reference of Methodology

Type (methodology, tool or module).	Reference ID, if applicable	Title	Version
Methodology	CDM: AMS-I.F	AMS-I.F: Renewable electricity for captive use and mini-grid	5.0
Tool	CDM: TOOL16	TOOL16: Project and leakage emissions from biomass	5.0
Tool	CDM: TOOL03	TOOL03: Tool to Calculate Project or Leakage CO2 Emissions from Fossil Fuel Combustion	03.0
Tool	CDM: TOOL12	TOOL12: Project and Leakage Emissions from Transportation of Freight	01.1.0
Tool	CDM: TOOL23	TOOL23: Additionality of first-of-its-kind project activities	03.0
Tool	CDM: TOOL21	TOOL21: Demonstration of additionality of small-scale project activities	13.1
Methodology	CDM: AMS-I.D	AMS-I.D: Grid connected renewable electricity generation	18.0

3.2 Applicability of Methodology

Methodology ID	Applicability condition	Justification of compliance
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<i>Example: VM0007</i>	<i>First applicability condition for given methodology, tool, or module</i>	<i>Justification that the project complies with this applicability condition</i>
AMS-I.F- Version 05.0- Renewable electricity generation for captive use and mini-grid	AMS-I.F- Paragraph 3 This methodology is applicable for project activities that (a) Install a new power plant at a site where there was no renewable energy power plant operating prior to the implementation of the project activity (Greenfield plant); (b) Involve a capacity addition, (c) Involve a retrofit of (an) existing plant(s); or (d) Involve a replacement of (an) existing plant(s).	The project activity revolves around the instillation of a new, Greenfield power plant at a site where there was no renewable energy power plant operating prior to the implementation of the project activity, thereby meeting the applicability of option (a).
AMS-I.F- Version 05.0- Renewable electricity generation for captive use and mini-grid	AMS-I.F- Paragraph 4: Table 2 Project displaces grid electricity consumption (e.g. grid import) and/or captive fossil fuel electricity generation at the user end (excess electricity may be supplied to a grid)	The project activity displaces grid electricity consumption or captive fossil fuel electricity generation at the user end. The Lothair facility, in the absence of the project activity, would be powered by the South African national grid or a coal-based captive power plant. The project activity displaces these carbon intensive power sources, thereby meeting the applicability condition.
AMS-I.F- Version 05.0- Renewable electricity generation for captive use and mini-grid	AMS-I.F- Paragraph 8 Combined heat and power (co-generation) systems are not eligible under this category.	The project activity revolves around a power-only plant and does not implement co-generation of heat and power.
AMS-I.F- Version 05.0- Renewable electricity generation for captive use and mini-grid	AMS-I.F- Paragraph 11 In the case the project activities utilizes biomass, the “TOOL16: Project and leakage emissions from biomass” shall be applied to determine the relevant project emissions from the	The project activity utilizes biomass residues, therefore TOOL16 shall be applied to determine the relevant project emissions from the cultivation of biomass and the utilization of biomass residues.

	cultivation of biomass and the utilization of biomass or biomass residues.	
TOOL16 – Version 05.0- Project and leakage emissions from biomass	For project activities which include biomass cultivation: (a) The land in which biomass is cultivated: (i) Does not contain wetlands; (ii) Does not contain organic soils as defined in paragraph 13(c); (iii) Is not subjected to flood irrigation. (b) The land in which biomass is cultivated: (i) Does not contain forest nor contained forest since 31 December 1989; or (ii) Contains a forest plantation that before the start of the project will be harvested and the land would be neither reforested nor will regenerate on its own into a forest in the absence of the project activity. (c) Desalination is not a substantial source of water in the host country. In case the land contains a forest plantation, the project participants shall demonstrate that before the start of the project activity the plantation will be finally harvested and regeneration to forestland (according to the respective national definition) will not take place. In doing so, the project proponent shall: (a) Identify realistic and credible alternatives with regard to the possible land use scenarios that would occur in the absence of the project activity, including but not limited to (i) The forest	The project activity consumes biomass residues, which are procured by the project proponent as captured in paragraph 8 (a) of the tool, and are the result of agro-industrial processes which are under the control of the project proponent, as captured in paragraph 8 (b). For these reasons, the project activity meets the applicability conditions of this tool.

	plantation continues under the current management practice; (ii) The forest plantation is harvested and the land is replanted; (iii) The forest plantation is harvested and the land is abandoned; (b) Assess the economic attractiveness of the existing forest plantation by applying Step 2 of the “TOOL01: Tool for the demonstration and assessment of additionality”; (c) Confirm, based on the plantation management practices in the region for the considered species, that the situation referred to in paragraph 7(b)(ii) is the common practice; and (d) Use relevant credible evidence, including but not limited to official land use maps, satellite images/aerial photographs, cadastral information, official land use records. (a) Procured by the project proponents; or (b) The result of an agro-industrial process under the control of the project proponents. The tool is also applicable if biomass residues are consumed in a CDM project activity, and the biomass residues can be utilized after processing or without processing. These could be: (a) Procured by the project proponents; or	
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	(b) The result of an agro-industrial process under the control of the project proponents.	
TOOL03- Version 03.0- Tool to Calculate Project or Leakage CO2 Emissions from Fossil Fuel Combustion	This tool provides procedures to calculate project and/or leakage CO2 emissions from the combustion of fossil fuels. It can be used in cases where CO2 emissions from fossil fuel combustion are calculated based on the quantity of fuel combusted and its properties. Methodologies using this tool should specify to which combustion process j this tool is being applied.	The project activity involves the use of small amounts of fossil fuels for the start-up of the biomass boiler as well as the use of mobile equipment for the handling of biomass on site. For this reason, this tool is applicable.
TOOL12 Version 01.1.0 – Project and Leakage Emissions from Transportation of Freight	This tool is applicable to project activities which involve freight transportation by road and where transportation is not the main project activity. This tool is not applicable to project activities where transportation is the main source of greenhouse gases emissions. This tool does not provide procedures to estimate baseline emissions from road transportation of freight. The tool only provides to determine CO2 emissions. CH4 and N2O emissions are excluded for simplification as they are small compared to CO2 emissions. In addition, the tool is applicable for the determination of project or leakage emissions	The Project will involve the transportation of biomass residues from sites beyond the project boundary to the project site using heavy vehicle trucks. However, transportation is not the main source of greenhouse gas emissions. Therefore, this tool is applicable. The Project will not rely on railway transport for the transportation of biomass to the plant.

	from freight transportation by rail in project activities where transportation is not the main project activity.	
TOOL23 Version 03.0 – Additionality of first-of-its-kind project activities	This methodological tool is applicable to project activities that wish to use the "first-of-its-kind" approach to demonstrate additionality and that use versions of baseline and monitoring methodologies, or the "Tool for the demonstration and assessment of additionality" or the "Combined tool to identify the baseline scenario and demonstrate additionality", which allow using the "first-of-its-kind" approach for demonstrating additionality.	This Project elects to use the "first-of-its-kind" approach to demonstrate additionality, therefore this tool is applicable.
TOOL21 Version 13.1- Demonstration of additionality of small-scale project activities	This methodological tool provides a general framework for demonstrating and assessing additionality and is applicable to a wide range of project types. The use of the methodological tool "Demonstration of additionality of small-scale project activities" is not mandatory for project participants when proposing new methodologies. Project participants and coordinating/managing entities may propose alternative methods to demonstrate additionality for consideration by the Executive Board. Project participants and coordinating/managing entities may also apply "TOOL19: Demonstration of additionality of microscale project activities" as applicable.	This methodological tool is applicable to a wide range of project types. Given the project activity is small-scale, this tool is applicable.
AMS-I.D Version 18.0- Grid connected renewable electricity generation	This methodology is applicable to project activities that: (a) Install a Greenfield plant; (b) Involve a capacity addition in (an) existing plant(s);	The procedures provided in AMS-I.D are prescribed by the methodology AMS-I.F for the calculation of the emission factor of an electric grid for the determination of

	(c) Involve a retrofit of (an) existing plant(s); (d) Involve a rehabilitation of (an) existing plant(s)/unit(s); or (e) Involve a replacement of (an) existing plant(s).	baseline emissions. For this reason, this methodology is applicable.
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3.3 Project Boundary

To be included in the validated version.

3.4 Baseline Scenario

To be included in the validated version.

3.5 Additionality

To be included in the validated version.

3.5.1 Regulatory Surplus

To be included in the validated version.

3.5.2 Additionality Methods

To be included in the validated version.

3.6 Methodology Deviations

To be included in the validated version.

4 QUANTIFICATION OF ESTIMATED GHG EMISSION REDUCTIONS AND REMOVALS

4.1 Baseline Emissions

To be included in the validated version.

4.2 Project Emissions

To be included in the validated version.

4.3 Leakage Emissions

To be included in the validated version.

4.4 Estimated GHG Emission Reductions and Carbon Dioxide Removals

To be included in the validated version.

5 MONITORING

5.1 Data and Parameters Available at Validation

To be included in the validated version.

5.2 Data and Parameters Monitored

To be included in the validated version.

5.3 Monitoring Plan

To be included in the validated version.

APPENDIX 1: COMMERCIALLY SENSITIVE INFORMATION

Use the table below to describe the commercially sensitive information included in the project description to be excluded in the public version.

Section	Information	Justification

APPENDIX X: <TITLE OF APPENDIX>

Use appendices for supporting information. Delete this appendix (title and instructions) where no appendix is required.